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Concerned local officials pull plugs on crypto kiosks

As scams proliferate, state also considers ban

By Scooty Nickerson
GLOBE STAFF

Amid a rise in scams, 20 communities have banned cryptocurrency kiosks, with more considering following suit, as Massachusetts legislators continue to debate a statewide prohibition.

Hundreds of crypto kiosks have popped up in convenience stores and gas stations across the Commonwealth in recent years, allowing customers to convert cash into bitcoin in minutes.

The machines have become a favorite tool of scammers, who use them to collect cash from victims. One local victim was undergoing cancer treatment in July 2024 when she was scammed by depositing \$5,500 into a kiosk in Haverhill — most of it given to her by her prayer group. It was nearly everything she had in savings.

Unlike regular bank ATMs, crypto kiosks in Massachusetts are largely unregulated by state banking authorities, despite allowing users to send tens of thousands of dollars in cash to anonymous online accounts. That leaves few opportunities for scam victims to get their money back.

Local officials pushing bans say efforts at the municipal level are stopgaps on a statewide problem, since scammers can simply direct victims to a nearby town that hasn't passed one.

"Why wait for [another] victim to come along before we do the right thing," said Beverly City Councilor Keith Sonia, who has pushed for

KIOSKS, Page A6

Testimony pivots to Clancy's claim of hearing voices

Psychologist talks of grim assessment after slayings

By Shelley Murphy and Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

This story may contain content readers find disturbing or triggering.

PLYMOUTH — Lindsay Clancy was handcuffed to a bed in the intensive care unit at Brigham and Women's Hospital, with two state troopers standing guard outside her door, when a psychologist showed up to evaluate whether she was competent to stand trial for killing her three children 11 days earlier.

The psychologist, Paul Zeizel, testified at Clancy's murder trial Tuesday that he was the first visitor allowed to see her after the slayings in January 2023, and only after her lawyer obtained a court order. She immediately asked to call her husband, according to Zeizel, who handed her his cellphone. The call went unanswered and Clancy left a message.

Two days later, Clancy tried again during Zeizel's second visit. This time, Clancy's then-husband, Patrick, picked up and Zeizel said he listened on speaker as the couple spoke for the first time since she strangled the children in the basement of their Duxbury home.

"She told Patrick that she loved him very much," Zeizel told jurors. "She said that she heard a male voice ordering her, telling her that

CLANCY, Page A7

Markey keeps lead over Moulton

Poll shows senator consolidating edge despite some concerns about his age

By Samantha J. Gross
and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

With two weeks until the state's Sept. 1 primary, US Senator Ed Markey leads US Representative Seth Moulton by double digits in their contentious Democratic Senate pri-

mary, a new Suffolk University/Boston Globe poll found, underscoring the 80-year-old Markey's political resiliency and Moulton's challenge in persuading undecided voters to embrace his calls for new leadership.

More than 52 percent of 500 likely primary voters said they would

choose or lean toward backing Markey if the election were held today, compared with roughly 38 percent who said they would pick Moulton. The 47-year-old Iraq War veteran has made Markey's age and seniority a central part of his challenge.

That would leave Moulton trailing Markey by more than 14 percentage points, with about 9 percent of the likely Democratic voters surveyed saying they're still undecided. The

9% of Democrats in the poll remained undecided. That is down from **20 percent** in April.

share of undecided voters has dwindled from April, when a Suffolk/Globe poll showed 20 percent undecided, with Markey enjoying a similar margin over Moulton.

The results suggest Moulton faces a steep climb in the final days of the

POLL, Page A5

Once a campsite, it's now grounds for a court case

Sale of former Girl Scouts land to developers in N.H. faces opposition



JIM DAVIS FOR THE GLOBE

Bette Higley (top) lives near the former Camp Menotomy on Lake Winnepesaukee and has joined a group spanning two states that opposes its sale. At right, scouts from several generations took in camp activities.



By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

LAKE WINNIPESAUKEE, N.H. — Summer after summer, s'more after s'more, a 95-acre plot of woods along the shore here was a second home for generations of girls.

Camp Menotomy, as it had been called since 1939, once crackled with life around this time of year. Before it shut down in 2023, Girl Scouts spent their days swimming, hiking, and tie-dyeing shirts in the shadow of the White MOUNTAINS, and their nights singing "rick-a-bamboo" under the stars.

Whether it will ever be that kind of place again may soon be decided two hours south in Massachusetts, where a court is weighing if it should live on as a campground for girls or be sold to a real estate developer for millions.

The case hinges on the wording of a 60-year-old deed, which calls for the land to be used as a camp benefiting young girls — specifically girls in Arlington, Mass. The trustees who oversee the land say the best way to continue doing

GIRL SCOUTS, Page A6



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

A SUN SETTING

The Connecticut Sun of the WNBA played their final game at TD Garden Tuesday night, beating Los Angeles, 85-77. To mark the event, the city held a fan festival on Canal Street (left) before the game. At one time, the hope was that Boston would host the team permanently, but it was sold and will move to Houston after this season. **C1.**



A some shiny day

Wednesday: Warmer, clearing. High 83-88, low 68-73.
Thursday: Partly sunny. High 81-86, low 63-68.
Sunrise: 5:55. Sunset: 7:39.
Weather and comics, **G6-7.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

potency of their products on labels. **B5.**

Angie Nixon, a progressive firebrand, won the Democratic nod for US Senate in Florida in a stunning upset. **A5.**

As warnings are given, experts offer tips on spotting and surviving rip currents. **B1.**

Several groups sued the Trump administration in a court in Boston over its tightening of rules regarding international student visas, saying the change would decimate the education sector. **B1.**

Regulators have cited more than a dozen Massachusetts marijuana growers for inflating the

Justice Dept. punished colleges despite lack of evidence, lawyer says

By Eric Tucker and
Alanna Durkin Richer
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — A Trump administration task force created to combat antisemitism pushed for settlements with Ivy League universities despite government investigations that were rushed and incomplete or that failed to establish legal violations by the schools, a former Justice Department lawyer alleged in a whistleblower disclosure obtained by the Associated Press.

The complaint alleges that the investigations into some of

the nation's most prestigious academic institutions were designed to strong-arm the schools into cutting deals for political purposes. Outcomes of the investigations were "predetermined, without regard to the evidence" in a "politically mandated effort" to extract money from schools through settlement demands and funding freezes under the pretext of rooting out antisemitism, the complaint alleges.

The work of the multiagency task force, launched by the Justice Department under

COLLEGES, Page A7

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